

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Saturday, May 30, 2020, via Zoom.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 9:05 a.m.

Mayor Lovett read the following statement: *This meeting is being conducted in accordance with the provisions of the Governor's Executive Order no. 2020-04 and the emergency meeting provisions of RSA 91-A to permit participation of board members by electronic means. Under the conditions of the current COVID-19 pandemic and the protocols established by the Centers for Disease Control (CDC), it is not reasonably practical for a quorum of this board's members to attend this meeting in person.*

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Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Erica Sweetser – Chambers – Councilor Stone

Assistant Mayor Allen Damren – Home – Alone

Mayor Charlene Lovett – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski – Restaurant – Alone

Ward II Councilor James Contois – Home – Alone

Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone – Chambers – Councilor Sweetser

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager

Mary Walter, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

None

CITIZEN'S FORUM

No one spoke.

NEW BUSINESS (BUDGET)

Mr. Morris gave an overview of the summary of the budget. This budget presents a .59% decrease, or 9 cents on the tax rate. The approved school budget is down 56 cents. It is important to maintain momentum in Claremont investments and projects, and it is important that Claremont invest in itself. We put a big portion of money in the paving budget. State Rooms & Meals tax may not be as bad as projected. Some people are struggling and there is a lot of federal help available. He cautioned the Council to not go too far in its reaction. We have a really tight budget. He asked directors for level-funded budgets, with few exceptions. We need to maintain momentum to rebuild roads and infrastructure.

Assessing

Department Request \$206,842 City Manager Proposed \$205,842

Mr. Morris said Amanda Benoit's position is changing a little bit. Consultation – he's planning a three-year agreement with Interim Assessor Steve Hamilton to supply Assessing services. It is difficult to find a qualified Assessor. He plans to contract with Steve Hamilton and Whitney Consulting Group. He's working with Kim Burkhamer, Assessing Technician, and trying to get her trained into the Assessor position. Re-evaluation line went down. Small increase in training for the Board of Assessors, and trying to get Kim and Amanda trained. Also, mileage went up. Postage is up a little. Vision software will be installed.

Ms. Walter said this budget is down 58%.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Assessing budget for \$205,842.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Planning & Development

Department Request \$830,846 City Manager Proposed \$825,446

Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director, said her department is the economic development department for the City. It has development staff as well as planning, zoning, building, health, and property codes, project management, boards and commissions, grant

administration, GIS, and marketing. The development team typically has 7 people, but they currently have 6. Funding for full staffing is in the budget. On the operation side, the budget is flat; there are no major changes. On the project side, the big item is Pleasant Street revitalization; others are Farwell Block, 56 Opera House Square, Washington and Bowen Streets, congestion mitigation (CMAQ) grant, and brownfield work at Sullivan Machine site; will resubmit grant for Elm to North Street sidewalk.

Mayor Lovett asked if staffing is sufficient. Ms. Merrill said the loss of an inspector is tough. She said all staff in her department work on grants; they contract with a grant writer for the CDBGs.

Mr. Morris said regarding grants that each department works on their own grants, but sometimes Planning helps out, when needed.

Regarding marketing, Ms. Merrill said she took a lot of it down when COVID-19 hit. Advertising is about 40% online and 60% radio and print. In the budget there is money to go out to bid for a fresher online presence. The new City website is expected to go live in the next couple of weeks.

There was a brief discussion about the \$4.5 million bond for Pleasant Street including head-in parking, wider sidewalks, parking behind buildings and change to the truck route (public hearings will be needed for that).

Ms. Walter said on the Pleasant Street bond, for \$4.5 million at 2.15% for 25 years would be \$234,570 a year. For a \$5.8 million bond, including \$1 million for upgrading equipment in the Police Department and some extra for contingency, the payment will be \$302,340. We are paying off three bonds at the end of FY2021 at \$340,112.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Planning & Development budget for \$825,446.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

TIFD-Downtown

Department Request \$745,250 City Manager Proposed \$745,250

Ms. Merrill said there is marketing money in this budget.

Ms. Walter said this budget is down 5%. There are still seven more years to pay on the TIFD (Tax Incremental Finance District) bond. It is coming close to a breakeven point.

There was a brief discussion about marketing in the TIFD.

Mr. Morris said it is important to market the City. If we move forward with the bond, we need marketing to bring people to Pleasant Street. Also, it is critical, when we come out of COVID-19 to entice people to come here. Reducing Marketing by \$10,000 will have an effect. Ms. Merrill agreed with Mr. Morris.

It was proposed to reduce Marketing by \$10,000. Most Councilors agreed.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. Damren to move the question.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the TIFD-Downtown budget for \$735,250.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-2.

Water

Department Request \$1,999,707.65 City Manager Proposed \$1,994,507

Mr. Morris talked about the energy reduction at the plant and that things are going well with the Water Department.

Victor St. Pierre, Public Works Director, said this is an enterprise fund and is run like a business. The water lines have been cleaned, so we are getting all of our water from White Water Reservoir. With the energy reduction, the plant is the second most energy efficient in New Hampshire. The City's water quality is good. Funding for the leak detection program is reflected in this budget. Last year, they found 107,000 gallons per day in leaks. They are working to finish removing all of the lead from the system. Also, they are working on the meter program; 3,300 meters have been changed and there are 160 to go. He talked about the distribution side. The City has 91 short streets with 2 inch, or smaller lines. He hopes to replace the water lines and then work on the roads above them.

There was a discussion about personnel and that where their time is charged depends upon where they are working. Mr. Morris said it is not just the salaries of the 4-5 people there, but also, if any other employees are doing work on a water project, they get charged to that account. When there is a repair under the street, road work will be needed.

It will be brought forward to the Council that the City does not want to increase the water fees this year. The Water Department is healthy.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Water budget for \$1,994,507.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - no

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Contois - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 5-4.

Sewer

Department Request \$2,717,360 City Manager Proposed \$2,710,960

Mr. Morris said the Sewer Department is doing well.

Mr. St. Pierre gave a brief overview of the department. The Sewer Department has 5 people and is fully staffed. All the lines are cleaned yearly. The biggest cost over the last few years has

been due to erosion. He talked about the blowers at the Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP) and the Eversource rebate that will be coming.

The new state permit is due in 18 months and he expects lower phosphorus and nitrogen requirements.

There was a request to put a monitor in City Hall for people to be able to see the progress from the solar array. Mr. St. Pierre hopes to also put it on the new website.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Sewer budget for \$2,710,960.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - no

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-3.

Sanitation (Transfer Station)

Department Request \$216,943 City Manager Proposed \$196,123

Mr. St. Pierre said the City is going out to bid for trash removal. Also, Public Works has had to do some testing for PFAS at the landfill. \$1,700 was budgeted for tire disposal, but people brought in 5,400 tires, at \$1.50 each. This helped clean up some tire dumps. This department has been affected by retirements. He was hoping to move the “give & take shop” into a trailer, but had to spend the money for tires, so it will stay as it is. He said there is difficulty finding volunteers to staff it, and at this point, there is no plan to reestablish it.

When asked if there was anything he would like to do differently, but doesn’t have funds for, Mr. St. Pierre said he would like to increase the area to do composting.

Regarding the landfill monitoring, Mr. St. Pierre said state requires testing any wells within 500 feet for PFAS. Mr. Morris said the City had one test come back higher than normal and the state had asked us to put in another monitoring well.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Sanitation (Transfer Station) budget for \$196,123.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - no
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 7-2.

Cemetery

Department Request \$189,367 City Manager Proposed \$192,617

Mr. Morris said the major change is that money was added for cemetery gates and pillars and cemetery roads. The cemetery gates are at the Pleasant Street cemetery. They are rusting and are hazardous.

Mountainview Cemetery has some road issues. Other than that, it is mostly level funded.

Mr. St. Pierre gave a brief overview.

Regarding perpetual care, Ms. Walter said a certain percentage of every headstone purchase is used to offset the Cemetery budget.

There was a discussion about whether or not people could make donations toward the cemetery gates and pillars. Yes, they can.

Mayor Lovett asked, in addition to the percentage given by the Trustees to offset cemetery costs, if we could ask for more for the gates and pillars because they pose a safety issue. Ms. Walter said she would find out. Mayor Lovett asked for \$8,000 to be transferred from the Cemetery Capital Reserve fund.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Cemetery budget for \$192,617.

Mayor Lovett said it is okay to tentatively pass this, but it will need to be revisited.

Roll call vote:
O'Hearne - no
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - no
Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-2.

Streets & Roads (Highways)

Department Request \$3,549,450.67 City Manager Proposed \$3,401,672

Mr. Morris referenced a highway maintenance presentation Council saw a couple of months ago, and he said \$200,000 was added to Paving. The focus is to get more money into roads and infrastructure projects, and to try to continue investing in Claremont.

Jeremy Clay, Assistant Public Works Director, said that four people retired and two shifted to other divisions. With those changes, they have lost 207 years of experience in 17 months. He said that preventative maintenance will save significant money. He talked about the asset management plan and the paving index, which he estimated that doing it in-house saved about \$40,000-\$50,000. This year, they changed the type of salt they used and they changed the amount of sand they put down (less to clean up); recycled about 4,500 tons of asphalt & concrete and used it out on the gravel roads; made gravel roads into sudo-paved roads which helped keep the dust down.

Mr. Clay asked if constituents have complaints about graffiti and the parking garage, etc., to funnel them to the City Manager, who will forward them to him.

There was a discussion about street markings wearing off. Mr. Clay talked about a program that is being tested in other parts of the state where they mill out 1/8 inch of the road and subset the marking. If it is successful, maybe the City could benefit.

Mr. Morris talked about Sidewalks and that previously money has been taken from that line. He has directed that the money in Sidewalks will be used for sidewalks only.

Regarding the Part-Time Employee increase, Mr. Morris said Norma Limoges, Office Manager, is retiring, so a part-time administrative secretary is being added to allow Ms. Limoges to spend time training the new Office Manager. This is a one-year position.

Several of the Councilors were in favor of adding the \$1,500 the department requested for Training.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Streets & Roads (Highways) budget for \$3,403,172 (adding \$1,500 for Training).

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - no

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - no
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 6-3.

At 12:16 p.m., Mayor Lovett stepped away and Assistant Mayor Damren took over.

Communications 911

Department Request \$550,087 City Manager Proposed \$560,678

Police Chief Mark Chase, talked about staffing. He said the Police Department continues to look to upgrade the equipment. They continue to contract with the Sullivan County Sheriff's office, Cornish, Lempster and Unity. Regarding a regionalized dispatch, Chief Chase said that it has been an ongoing discussion for 25 years. The City Manager has been working on this, but it is still in the planning stages.

Mr. Morris said as part of the \$5.8 million bond, the City is asking for about \$1 million for a dispatch center. He's hoping it won't be needed. The money is to replace the City's radio equipment. He's been working with Newport and Sullivan County on this. They are putting together a management plan. They will do cost sharing. Between Claremont and Newport, it will be about \$500,000 each. If we can't make this happen, the City needs to move forward with the equipment purchase.

At 12:26 p.m., Mayor Lovett returned.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to tentatively approve the Communications 911 budget for \$560,678.

Roll call vote:
O'Hearne - yes
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Police

Department Request \$2,970,020 City Manager Proposed \$3,012,297

Chief Chase talked about staffing, including those who have completed the Academy, those who are going to the Academy, new hires, and those who have left, including Deputy Chief Brent Wilmot. They still have two open positions, and are hoping to start testing soon.

They contract prosecution services. Regarding the active shooter event last year, he said he is grateful for all departments working together and for the support of the citizens of Claremont. He continued on with his overview, including CALEA Accreditation, body and cruiser cameras, and the addition of the canine program, Sully.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to tentatively approve the Police budget for \$3,012,297.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-1.

Fire

Department Request \$2,533,753 City Manager Proposed \$2,534,087

Mr. Morris said there is an increase for the traffic light program, increase in Technology/Internet for software update, and Maintenance for fire trucks.

Fire Chief Bryan Burr gave an overview of the department including staffing: 18 full-time firefighters, 4 shifts of 4 and 8 call personnel. He also listed the equipment in the department. The department schedules the household hazardous waste collection days and maintains two fire alarm systems. There are under 20 wired box systems and over 125 radio boxes on the network.

Ms. Walter said there was a mistake in the Regular Pay, so \$4,900 needed to be dropped from the bottom line.

Chief Burr gave a history of 5-man staffing versus 4-man staffing. He talked about adding 3 people through the 2014 SAFER (Staffing for Adequate Fire and Emergency Response) grant and losing those numbers through attrition. They are at 4 shifts of 4 people. He said he is not happy with the 4-man shifts, but they will continue to do their jobs.

Mr. Koloski said as a Call Firefighter, he sees the strain during the initial attack of a fire. He would like to see the Fire Department get back to adequate staffing.

Ms. Kier was in favor of adding another firefighter position.

Ms. Walter said the average cost of a new firefighter is \$105,000 with benefits which does not include uniforms and PPE (personal protective equipment).

Regarding the City's ISO (Insurance Service Office) rating, Chief Burr said the next rating will be in 2022. The City may lose some of its rating because of manning, but may increase some rating because of the hydrant flow testing.

When asked about the tax impact of one additional firefighter, Ms. Walter said \$110,000 would equal 15 cents on the tax rate.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. Damren to move the question.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - no

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-2.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Fire budget for \$2,529,187.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no

Sweetser - no

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-3.

Airport

Department Request \$152,965

City Manager Proposed \$152,965

Chief Burr gave an overview of the Airport. Aviation fuel is the main income.

The City owns three aircraft hangars. The other two generate income for the FBO (Fixed Base Operator). The runway reconstruction project is scheduled for 2021/2022.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Ms. Sweetser to tentatively approve the Airport budget for \$152,965

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Parks

Department Request \$397,517

City Manager Proposed \$390,974

Mr. Morris said there will be revenue issues because of COVID-19.

Mark Brislin, Parks and Recreation Director, gave an overview of both Parks and the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center (CSBCC). His department oversees ten parks, which is approximately 550 acres. The CSBCC averages 7,300 member check-ins per month. The normal hours are Monday through Thursday 5:30 a.m.-9:00 p.m., Friday 5:30 a.m.-7:00 p.m., and Saturday and Sunday 8:00 a.m.-6:00 p.m. He listed the programs including youth & adult sporting programs, and special events. Last year, they completed phase 2 of the Monadnock Park playground project which was LWCF (Land and Water Conservation Fund) grant funded.

Regarding the JSL (Junior Sports League) building, Mr. Morris said a couple of groups are looking at the building.

There was a brief discussion of combining the Parks and the CSBCC budgets and it was agreed to place it on a future agenda.

A motion was made by Ms. Contois and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Parks budget for \$390,974.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

CSB Community Center – Recreation

Department Request \$1,160,492 City Manager Proposed \$1,150,390

Mr. Brislin said this has been a challenging time. It has been hard to open with current restrictions. They will start with a soft opening soon.

Regarding the level-funded budget, Mr. Morris said a lot of this was prepared right before COVID-19 hit. He's hoping to open the CSBCC by July.

Ms. Kier said she has a sister-in-law who works as a fitness trainer at CSBCC. She asked if she should recuse herself. No one asked her to recuse herself.

There was a question about unemployment and Ms. Walter said that it is expected to go up in all departments.

Regarding energy efficiency measures, Mr. Brislin said a big one was the switch to LED lights which was completed at the end of last year.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the CSB Community Center – Recreation budget for \$1,150,390.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Welfare

Department Request \$386,902 City Manager Proposed \$391,902

Mr. Morris said the Rent line was increased. Also, \$10,000 was put in to assist the homeless shelter. Many communities put money in to help their shelter.

Suzanne Carr, Welfare Director, gave an overview of her department. She has a two-person department. They help 200-300 families each year. They work closely with other state and local organizations. When she began 30 years ago, there were three people in the office. The largest portion of the budget goes to housing. This budget was prepared prior to the pandemic. She talked about after the eviction moratorium is done. Southwestern Community Services (SWCS)

is reaching out to landlords to see if they have rental delinquencies and if they can start helping. SWCS is receiving funding from the CARES Act. She's hoping that will help with the housing line item. She said the intention is to have SWCS present to the Council what their services are and the impact on the Welfare budget. She said currently, Claremont is the only city in the state that doesn't contribute to the shelter in their own community.

Ms. Carr said she is concerned about housing, especially in July when the extra federal unemployment money runs out.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Welfare budget for \$391,902.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Library

Department Request \$405,640

City Manager Proposed \$401,942

Mr. Morris said Technology was reduced, keeping in line with what has actually been spent.

Michael Grace, City Librarian, gave an overview of his department including circulation of over 65,000 items. There are 3 full-time employees and 7 part-time. His request included restoration of a person that was removed from the 2018 budget and restoration of \$10,000 for Books, also removed in 2018; \$1,000 in the Electricity line was to cover the increased usage due to the addition of the air conditioner. There was an error on page 61, column 4, \$500 in Furniture should be in Periodicals. Column 5, \$500 for Furniture is correct.

Mr. Grace said the Children's Librarian retired, but the position was not filled. Marta Smith moved to cover that and Adult Services. He would like to hire a Children's Librarian and have Ms. Smith full-time in Adult Services. Reduced staffing makes it difficult to properly monitor what is going on, on the two floors, and with the two entrances/exits.

Ms. Kier is in favor of adding the position.

Mr. Grace said with the proposed budget, the Library will be able to provide services, but it is not ideal.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to tentatively approve the Library budget for \$403,442.00 (adding \$500 for Periodicals and \$1,000 for Electricity).

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no, without the added position

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-1.

Mr. Damren noted this is a tentative approval based on a determination whether or not to add the additional position.

Policy

Department Request \$606,170

City Manager Proposed \$579,870

Mr. Morris gave an overview of this budget. \$10,000 was added to the CCTV (Claremont Community Television) passthrough. A request will be made to encumber money from Property Maintenance for outside property maintenance and clean-up of properties.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Policy budget for \$579,870

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Outside Agency Request

Department Request \$30,000 City Manager Proposed \$30,000

Mr. Morris said this is the \$30,000 for Southwestern Community Services for bus service. Ms. Walter said this comes from fund balance.

A motion was made by Mr. O'Hearne and seconded by Mr. Damren to tentatively approve the Outside Agency Request budget for \$30,000.

Mr. Koloski asked for an update from SWCS including what other communities contribute. He said he won't vote yes on this budget without the information.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

At 3:10 p.m. Council took a break; Ms. Kier didn't return from break.

City Administration (Finance)

Department Request \$881,438 City Manager Proposed \$879,438

Ms. Walter said this budget is below last year's. The increase to the Temporary/Seasonal line is due to having both the state and presidential election this coming year.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to tentatively approve the City Administration (Finance) budget for \$879,438.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - absent

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0, with 1 absent.

Municipal Complex (Maintenance)

Department Request \$404,559 City Manager Proposed \$371,459

Ms. Walter gave an overview; the roof is a concern. Work is being done on the flat roof and the HVAC (Heating, ventilation, and air conditioning). Heating fuel was locked in at \$1.46 and propane was locked in at \$1.14.

At 3:29 p.m. Ms. Kier returned.

There was a discussion about the roof repair being so expensive and Ms. Walter said because rates are so low now, it would be wise to roll that money into the bond.

There was a discussion about the roof repairs and requests to see if there are any grants available for that.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Municipal Complex (Maintenance) budget for \$371,459.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Elections

Department Request \$15,700 City Manager Proposed \$15,700

Ms. Walter said this year there will be a presidential and a state election.

Ms. Walter said the voting machines are holding up fine.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the Elections budget for \$15,700.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Debt Retirement (Debt Service)

Department Request \$1,155,003 City Manager Proposed \$1,155,003

Ms. Walter said this is down \$15,000. FY2021 is the last year for three bonds and that will free up about \$340,000. She said the City could have debt up to \$22 million and the City is well under that at less than \$8 million.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Debt Retirement (Debt Service) budget for \$1,155,003.

Roll call vote:
O'Hearne - yes
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

General Services

Department Request \$1,093,697 City Manager Proposed \$914,869

Ms. Walter said this is generally a department where things are not necessarily attributable to one department (i.e. Legal Services, Auditing Services, Ambulance, Memorial Day, Computer Replacement, Property & Liability Insurance, Retirement Reserve with offsetting revenue, GASB Liability (not funded for 3-4 years), Contract Negotiations, Overlay and War Service Credits, and Loan to Downtown TIFD). The Loan to Downtown TIFD needs to be changed to \$130,930 because Council cut \$10,000 on the other end. This budget is down from last year. GASB Liability should be funded at \$150,000 every year. It's a future liability.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to tentatively approve the General Services budget for \$904,869.

Roll call vote:
O’Hearne - yes
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Revenue

Department Request \$5,474,257.75 City Manager Proposed \$5,974,757.75

Ms. Walter talked about the Land Use Change tax and that the first \$5,000 goes to the Conservation Commission. The Yield taxes is for timber cuts. What is taken in for Revenue fluctuates. She is concerned about the Interest on Taxes because of the Board of Assessment abatements. Mr. Morris said for those abatements, people would have to show a COVID hardship.

Ms. Walter said the Meals & Rooms tax is estimated to be lower based on what she has heard from DRA. She’s being conservative at \$450,000.

Ms. Walter said the plan was to use \$500,000 from fund balance toward the tax rate and \$30,000 for the bus service and \$157,240 to fund the Downtown TIFD.

A motion was made by Mr. Contois and seconded by Ms. Kier to tentatively approve the Revenue budget for \$5,974,757.75.

Roll call vote:
O’Hearne - yes
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 4:07 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. O’Hearne and seconded by Mr. Contois to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council